

CHAPTER TWELVE

Special Considerations for Skimo and Ski Mountaineering

In this chapter we'll give you some ski-specific information to help you get the most from your plan, including example weeks for special situations that arise during the competition season.

The best way to improve your winter skimo results and ski mountaineering experience is to spend a summer running many hours and many thousands of vertical meters in the mountains. While running uphill is similar to skinning, adding ski simulations in your workouts such as Ski Striding, Hill Bounding, and roller skiing, along with ski-specific muscular endurance during late summer and early fall to a good summer of mountain running, will help your transition into on-snow training.

The main distinction between skimo and ski mountaineering is the tempo and hence intensity of uphill skinning. Due to the weight of the equipment (skis, boots, and pack) needed for ski mountaineering and the potential for breaking trail in deep snow, the arm and leg turnover is much slower than in skimo. This additional weight means that muscular endurance is a bigger factor in determining your performance in ski mountaineering. Ski mountaineer training hence needs added ME work in place of Zone 3 and Zone 4 interval training.

Structuring a Category 1 Athlete’s Skimo and Ski Mountaineering Plan

The following section includes different example weeks for a Category 1 athlete. These example weeks are meant to be used along with the preceding information on how to plan, monitor, and adjust your training. This structure applies to both skimo and ski mountaineering. Ski mountaineering should emphasize muscular endurance strength training.

Example Early Base Period Week. Category 1

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Rest day.		This can be a good day to take off or use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
Day 2	Strength: Use the strength assessment on page 205 to determine what stage of strength is appropriate. Use that workout. Hill Bounding for more advanced athletes.	Optional second workout: Upper-body ME (see page 218).	Keep strength workouts separated by 72 hours.
Day 3	Aerobic base: Up to 25% of weekly vertical.	Optional second workout: Zone 1 or Recovery. Up to 10% of weekly vertical.	If ADS, use Z2. If no ADS, stay mostly in Z1. If on skis or roller skis, add 8x15 sec quick-tempo uphill with 3 min easy between.
Day 4	Recovery workout: Done at Z1 or Recovery heart rate, depending on fatigue. At least 15% of weekly time.	Off.	Done on flat-to-gentle terrain.
Day 5	Strength: General or Specific. If Tuesday is Hill Bounding, then today is ME workout.	Optional second workout: Zone 1 or Recovery. Up to 10% of weekly vertical.	
Day 6	Aerobic base: Up to 20% of weekly vertical.	Off.	If ADS, use Z2. If no ADS, stay mostly in Z1. If on skis or roller skis, add 8x15 sec quick-tempo uphill with 3 min easy between.
Day 7	Aerobic base: Zone 1. Done on hilly terrain. Up to 40% of weekly vertical.	Off.	Stay in zone even if it means walking some hills.

Fig. 12.1 Example of an Early Base-Building Week

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.

Ski Simulations

Running uphill bears a strong resemblance to skiing uphill. However, there are enough differences that make it worth exploring more ski-specific movements for your summer and fall training. Cross-country skiers have developed a few dryland ski simulation movements used for different types of training. We have already discussed Ski Bounding (see illustration below) as a strength exercise. For long Zones 1–2 uphill, use Ski Striding to imitate the longer stride length allowed by the glide of the ski on the snow. For Zone 3 workouts, they use Elghuf (Moose Hoofing), which is a loping, long stride somewhere between Ski Bounding and the Ski Striding in intensity.



Fig. 12.2 Moose Hoofing

This type of movement is best described as low-intensity bounding. It is not a run because you are exaggerating the stride length and reaching farther out in front of your body with the uphill leg. It is intended to simulate ski striding up a hill at an intensity you can sustain for minutes rather than the seconds you can sustain actual bounding.



Fig. 12.3 Ski Bounding

Bounding is an explosive, exaggerated stride meant to act as specific strength and power training for skiers. As such it should be used in short and very powerful sets lasting only seconds at maximum power. Strive for maximum time in the air and an explosive push-off.



Fig. 12.4 Ski Striding

This movement is used to simulate skiing uphill and intended for long-duration lower-intensity training. It more closely mimics skiing than does running, but is best done on uphills and then switching back to running on the flats.



ATHLETE STORIES

Specific Training for a Specific Goal

Javier Martín de Villa

“Why would you want to move to Granada?” A Spanish Mountain Federation manager was helping me with the paperwork that would secure my transfer to the university there.

I explained that I wanted to place top three in the world championships the following year, and that I’d be able to train more effectively in Granada, which is near the Sierra Nevada, than if I continued studying in Madrid.

Trying to be polite, he told me that maybe I was being a little too ambitious. That I should be more realistic about my expectations. His words only enhanced my resolve, motivating me to follow through with my plan rather than abandon it.

That spring, during the 2003 European Championships of Ski Mountaineering in Slovakia, I had finished far below expectations. I was determined to perform better at the 2004 World Championships of Ski Mountaineering, especially because it would take place in the Pyrenees, in my home country of Spain. My coach, Jose, and I collaborated on a plan; something had to change if I wanted to finish strong.

At the start of the summer we reviewed my previous five years of training and analyzed the specific requirements of the 2004 championships. I wanted to prepare in the best possible manner. We knew the date of the event, so we had a time frame for the training plan. We knew I would participate in the vertical and individual races, but not the team race, with the primary goal being the individual race; my focus would be racing from forty minutes to a maximum of two hours. We knew the races would

start at 2,000 meters, so altitude would be a serious consideration. And we knew that the individual race would consist of three to four long climbs with technical downhill, for a combined vertical gain of around 1,600 meters.

Once we had all this information, we mapped out a plan that would build toward the one clear goal of placing well at—and ideally winning—the world championships the following March. But first we had to fit the training into my day-to-day life.

At the time, I was balancing my athletic career with my university studies in Madrid, so I couldn’t dedicate all my time to training. During the winter I could rarely escape the city more than three days a week to ski. Now, motivated by this goal race, I made the decision to move to Granada, where I could continue my university studies while living just forty minutes from a ski resort that starts at 2,100 meters and rises to 3,400 meters. That altitude profile was a perfect match for the 2004 world championship course, and I’d be able to increase my number of days on skis.

I tried to accumulate as much volume as possible that summer and fall when I had more time and the days were longer. Once the snow started, my average weekly volume was twelve hours of endurance training (just counting uphill time when skiing), plus two days of strength training.

My coach and I also designed three higher impact “shock weeks.” The first one fell in mid-October, when I went to the annual training camp at Tignes in France with the Spanish national team. The goal was to accumulate the maximum possible volume on skis—twenty

to twenty-five hours in a week. This would be the culmination of the high-volume period of my training, and the aim was to have it transfer over to the specific action of ski mountaineering racing.

The second shock week was set for over my winter break from university, and it involved a combination of volume and high-intensity workouts. It marked the start of the high-intensity period, where I focused on race pace and the specific requirements of the goal race. A third and final shock week started with a vertical race and ended with the Spanish Championship; the main goal of this week was to make all my final race-specific adjustments—to fine-tune gear, strategies, and pace.

Poised at the starting line of the world championship individual race in March, I recalled what that Spanish Mountain Federation manager had said to me about my move to Granada. Despite what he believed about my ambitions, I knew that I had to be the best version of myself to get the best outcome.

I came in second place in the espoir division. Denis Trento and I fought to the very end, but about 100 meters from the finish line on the final downhill, we both crashed. He got up before I did and won by seconds. My specific work over the course of the season—both in terms of conditioning and technical training—was critical to achieving this proud result. ■

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The art of the quick transition. Spanish national team members showing how it's done during the Pierra Menta in 2016. France. Photo: Ulysse Lefebvre

Skimo Technical Aspects

Skimo is a sport with a very large technical component and while fitness plays the main role in performance, ignoring technique will put a ceiling on your race results. Space constraints prevent us from covering skimo technique other than to mention a few areas that require lots of practice.

- Transitions
- Kick turns
- Skin management
- Boot packing
- High-tempo skinning
- Downhill fast skiing

It can be best to first learn how to do these in a low-pressure, low-intensity setting with some coaching. If you can't do them slowly and with control, you will

never do them well under pressure and at speed. As you improve these skills, a fun way to add challenge is by finding a short course that includes several of these skills and which takes 10 to 15 minutes to complete. After a nice warm-up you can run through the course at an intensity like Z3 (not maximum)—fast enough to challenge your skills but not so fast as to be exhausting. You want to reinforce *good* technique, so focus on staying in control and allowing your proficiency to develop over a period of weeks and months. Start with one workout per week doing one lap through the circuit. Then, as you become both fitter and more proficient, add more laps, taking a few minutes of rest between laps during which you think about where you made mistakes and how you can avoid them the next time.

Example Recovery Week. Category 1

These recovery weeks are vital to long-term progression in training load. The focus is on recovery this week; you are not adding to your fitness base. You want to get recovered as well and as quickly as possible so you are ready to start building fitness again. This week should be loosely structured. By Sunday you should feel like attacking the next week. If not, you didn't recover well enough. Insert alternative recovery training like swimming or easy cycling, or any other favored recovery activity.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Rest day.	Off.	This can be a good day to take off or use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
Day 2	Recovery workout: Do full run at Recovery heart rate. 20% of weekly time.	Off.	Stay in the zone. Done on flat-to-gentle terrain.
Day 3	Aerobic base run: Z2. 20% of weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 4	Strength: Cut your normal strength workout by 50%.	Off.	
Day 5	Rest day.	Off.	
Day 6	Recovery workout: Do full run at Z1 heart rate. 20% of weekly time.	Off.	Stay in the zone. Done on flat-to-gentle terrain.
Day 7	Aerobic base: Up to 40% of weekly vertical.	Off.	If ADS, use Z2. If no ADS, stay mostly in Z1. If on skis or roller skis, add 8x15 sec quick-tempo uphill with 3 min easy between.

Fig. 12.5 Example of a Recovery Week in the Early Base Period

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.



The start of any skimo race is a blur of action. Pierra Menta, France. Photo: Ulysse Lefebvre

Example Week Skimo Precompetition Period. Category 1

When you get to within two months of your first competition, the training focus must shift to more race-specific workouts with the inclusion of high intensity in Zone 3. Some points to remember:

- Replace the Zone 2 workouts with one Zone 3. Zone 3 workouts will be stressful.
- Maintain the aerobic base with Zone 1 volume.
- Reduce any leg-oriented specific ME training because of the muscular demands of the Zone 3 workouts.
- Maintain upper-body ME work with one workout every seven days.
- General or Specific (Hill Bounding) and Core Strength can be maintained with one workout every seven to ten days.
- Continue quick-tempo work with pick-ups in one aerobic workout/week.

	AM	PM	Comments
MON	Rest day.		This can be a good day to take off or use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
TUE	Strength: upper-body ME and core. See page 218 in Strength section.	Optional second workout: Z1 base workout up to 8% of weekly vertical.	
WED	Zones 1–3: up to 15% of weekly vertical. With 5–7% in Z3. Warm-up to include 8x10–20 sec quick-tempo with 2 min easy ski recovery.	Core strength.	Use ski-specific mode for Z3 work: ski, roller ski, or ski simulations. Progress from shorter to longer duration. Intervals or continuous.
THU	Recovery: done at Z1 or recovery. At least 15% of weekly time.	Optional second workout: Z1 or recovery on gentle terrain.	Stay in the zone. Done on flat-to-gentle terrain.
FRI	Strength: Hill Bounding steeply up.	Optional second workout: Z1 or recovery. Up to 5% of weekly vertical.	
SAT	Z1: up to 15% of weekly vertical.		If feeling recovered, OK to add some Zones 3–4 at end as a progressive distance in later weeks.
SUN	Aerobic base: up to 40% of weekly vertical.	Off.	If ADS, use Z2. If no ADS, stay mostly in Z1. If on skis or roller skis, add 8x15 sec quick-tempo uphill with 3 min easy between.

Fig. 12.6 Example Week for Precompetition Period

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.



A skin track crosses Pointe du Dard, Beaufortain, France. Photo: Ulysse Lefebvre

Structuring a Category 2 Athlete's Skimo and Ski Mountaineering Plan

The following section includes example weeks for Category 2 athletes. You have significant training experience now; it is our aim that the following information can give new insights and some new tools to modify and adjust what may already have brought you some successes.

Early Base Period

As a more advanced athlete, you have probably spent the summer building a solid aerobic base supplemented with strength training and are well prepared for the skimo-specific work. You will still be wise to dedicate a couple of weeks to a high volume of ski-specific aerobic base training. Kilian likes to do a fall glacier training camp with a high volume of low-intensity, skimo-specific training. He also makes use of roller skis during this period. You may not have the opportunity to hit the glacier in September, but your goal is the same: to spend a lot of time on ski-specific base training.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Rest day.		This can be a good day to take off or use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
Day 2	Core and ME for upper body and legs. See upper body and core exercises in Strength section.	Second workout: recovery workout. Up to 5% of weekly vertical.	
Day 3	Z1: 15% of weekly vertical. If on skis or roller skis, include 8x15 sec pick-ups with 3 min easy between.	Optional second workout: Z1 or recovery. Up to 5% of weekly vertical.	Z2 if you suffer from ADS.
Day 4	Z2: long uphill skimo specific. Start with 10% of weekly vertical.	Second workout: recovery. Up to 5% of weekly vertical.	After at least 6 weeks, you can introduce some Z3 into this workout.
Day 5	Strength: Hill Bounding.	Optional second workout: Z1 or recovery. Up to 10% of weekly vertical.	
Day 6	Z2: 10% of weekly vertical.	Off.	If on skis or roller skis, include 8x15 sec at high-tempo striding uphill with 3 min easy between.
Day 7	Aerobic base: Z1. Up to 40% of weekly vertical.	Off.	Z2 if you suffer from ADS.

Fig. 12.7 Example Week for Early Skimo Base-Building Period

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Rest day.	Off.	This can be a good day to take off or use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
Day 2	ME. See page 218 in Strength section and core strength.	Recovery activity.	
Day 3	Z1 or recovery. Stay in the zone. Up to 10% of weekly vertical.	Off.	Best if foot borne, outdoors on hilly terrain. But laps in a tall building or time on a treadmill or stair machine can be substituted.
Day 4	Z1 or recovery. Stay in the zone. Up to 10% of weekly distance and vertical.	Off.	Best if foot borne, outdoors on hilly terrain. But laps in a tall building or time on a treadmill or stair machine can be substituted.
Day 5	Z2 vertical. Up to 15% of weekly vertical.	Off.	Best if foot borne, outdoors on hilly terrain. But laps in a tall building or time on a treadmill or stair machine can be substituted.
Day 6	Z1: up to 25% of weekly vertical. Can be Z2 if suffering from ADS.	Off.	Late in the preparation phase, these days should be spent on skis.
Day 7	Z1: up to 40% of weekly vertical. Can be Z2 if suffering from ADS.	Off.	Late in the preparation phase, these days should be spent on skis.

Fig. 12.8 Example of Base and Specific Week for Ski Mountaineer Preparing for Multiday Ski Touring Trip

Note: The ME work is a high priority, especially if you do not get a chance to ski much in the winter. The only difference between the Base and Specific weeks is the overall volume.



The joy of skiing uphill. Photo: Kilian Jornet

Skimo Middle and Late Weeks – Precompetition Period

Start to add high intensity workouts no later than two months before your first competition.

Some suggestions:

- When Zone 3 volume is 5 percent of weekly vertical, replace Zone 2 workouts with Zone 1.
- Reduce any leg-oriented ME training in the gym because of the muscular demands of the Zone 3 workouts.
- Maintain upper-body ME work with one workout every seven to ten days.
- Hill Bounding and Core Strength one workout every week.
- Continue high-tempo work with pick-ups in one aerobic workout per week.
- After four weeks of Zone 3 workouts, introduce some shorter Zone 4 interval training one day each week. If you have little experience with Zone 4 intervals, consider beginning with 30/30s. When you first add Zone 4, do it by reducing the Zone 3 time to about 50 percent of the time you are in Zone 4. See how you handle this jump in intensity and adjust accordingly.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Rest day.		May use for light recovery activities after a big weekend of training.
Day 2	Zones 1–3 ski specific. Start with 15% of weekly vertical with 5–7% in Z3.	Recovery workout. Up to 5% of weekly vertical.	Z3 can be done as a tempo, progressive distance, or intervals.
Day 3	Recovery workout. At least 10% of weekly time.	Strength: upper-body ME and core.	Stay in the zone. Done on flat-to-gentle terrain.
Day 4	Z1: 15% of weekly vertical. Warm-up to include: 8–10x20 sec quick-tempo with 2-minute recovery.	Recovery. Up to 5% of weekly time.	
Day 5	Z1: up to 20% of weekly vertical.	Recovery if doing intervals. Otherwise Z1. Up to 5% of weekly time or vertical.	Z2 if ADS. Optional: later weeks, add Z4 intervals. Z4 time less than 5% of total weekly volume/vertical.
Day 6	Strength: Hill Bounding.	Z1 or recovery. Up to 10% of weekly time/vertical.	
Day 7	Aerobic base: Z1. About 30% of weekly vertical.		Z2 if ADS.

Fig. 12.9 Example Week for Skimo Late Base/Precomp Period

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.

Training During Race Season for Category 1 and 2 Athletes

The training outlined above is designed to bring you into racing shape by the early season but still allow for performance gains as the season progresses. Races will serve to build the race-specific speed endurance. If you race often, a real challenge can be to maintain the aerobic base. It is hard to get in the longer Zones 1 and 2 days, let alone any hard workouts, when you are trying to recover enough to keep racing frequently. You may need a couple of days of tapering, a day of travel going to the race, and a couple of days for travel and recovery after a race before you feel like you can train effectively again. That schedule doesn't allow much time for training between races.

Managing training around racing is challenging, even for the very best. Unless you are at a high level of fitness, trying to squeeze much productive training between races separated by only five or six days with two days largely taken up by travel risks reducing the next race's performance.

Some suggestions for the racing season:

- The bigger your training base, the more easily you can manage the intensity of frequent races. This takes years of consistent training to build. Racing too much and too often with a small base will lead to a decline in performance.
- Prioritize your races: A races are the main focus of the season. B races are less important, but you may want a day or two of lighter training before them. C races are those that you use as hard workouts and train through.
- If possible, plan for one or two training blocks of two to three weeks between races partway through the season when you can return the focus to training. You might do this training block around one or two C races or leading into a B race. This will help you maintain your fitness all the way through the season.
- Below we've listed example plans for how you might handle three typical mid-season scenarios.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Day after last race. Active recovery: stretch, swim, foam roll. Light recovery workout if feeling good.		For volume/vertical, these weeks use average volume/vertical from mid Base Period weeks.
Day 2	Recovery workout, 5-10% weekly vertical.	Core Strength.	
Day 3	Z1: 15% weekly vertical.	Hill Bounding, 6x15 sec.	Maintain strength through the season.
Day 4	Z2: 15% weekly vertical. Warm-up to include 8-10x20 sec quick-tempo with 2-minute recovery.	Off.	
Day 5	Z1: 15% weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 6	Z4: 10% weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 7% of total weekly volume.	Off.	
Day 7	Z1: 35% weekly vertical.	Core Strength.	

Fig. 12.10 Sample Training Plan for a Three Week Break in Race Schedule to Rebuild Capacity

Note: The percentages in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 8	Recovery activity.	Off.	For volume, these weeks use average volume in mid Base Period weeks.
Day 9	Zones 1-3: 15% weekly vertical. 10% of weekly vertical in Z3.	Off.	Try to do Z3 as long tempo.
Day 10	Recovery ski. 5% weekly volume on mellow terrain.	Hill Bounding, 6x15 sec.	Maintain strength through the season.
Day 11	Z1: 10% weekly vertical. Warm-up includes 8-10x20 sec quick-tempo with 2-min recovery.	Off.	
Day 12	Recovery ski: 10% weekly vertical.	Core Strength.	
Day 13	C or B priority race or Z4 intervals. 15% of weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 10% of total weekly volume.	Recovery ski: 10% weekly vertical.	Do longer cool-down after race.
Day 14	Long Z1: 35% weekly vertical.	Off.	

Fig. 12.10 Continued, week 2

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 15	Active recovery: stretch, swim, foam roll.	Off.	
Day 16	Z1-Z3: up to 10% weekly vertical. 5-7% in Z3.	Off.	
Day 17	Recovery ski: 15% weekly vertical.	Hill Bounding, 6x15 sec.	Maintain strength through the season.
Day 18	Z1: 35% weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 19	Z1 ski: 15% weekly vertical with 6x15 sec quick-tempo pick-ups.	Off.	
Day 20	Travel day. Try to ski on the course to preview. If not racing, then Z1: 20-25% of weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 21	A or B race. If not racing, then Z4 intervals: 15% of weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 10% of weekly volume.	Recovery ski: 5% weekly vertical.	

Fig. 12.10 Continued, week 3



Christina Lustenberger and Tanner Flanagan putting in the track above Rogers Pass, British Columbia, Canada. Photo: Fredrik Marmasater

Scenario One: Recharging the capacity bank account.

If and when you find yourself with a sizable gap (two or three weeks) between races, you'd be smart to drop back and do some basic capacity-building work. This will leave you a bit fatigued, so don't plan an A priority race during the training block. Targeting an A or B priority race or event at the end of this period will require some lighter training for a few days beforehand. This longer break between races will be enough time for you to get in some productive base training and still have time to recover from that training before the next important race.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Z1 or recovery pace on gentle terrain. Or recovery activity, if needed.	Off.	Spend additional time on recovery if needed.
Day 2	Z1/recovery pace on gentle terrain. Or recovery activity.	Off.	Spend additional time on recovery if needed.
Day 3	Z1–Z4 ski: 15% weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 5% of weekly volume.	Off.	
Day 4	Hill Bounding, 6x10 sec with 2-min recovery between.	Off.	
Day 5	Travel. Easy run or ski post travel.	Off.	
Day 6	A level race.	Off.	
Day 7	Long Z1 or recovery pace before travel.	Off.	

Fig. 12.11 Sample Two-Week Plan for Training Between Important Races

Note: Percentages given in these tables are rough guidelines, not exact amounts.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 8	Active recovery: stretch, yoga, foam roll, swim.	Off.	Spend additional time on recovery.
Day 9	Z1-4 ski: 10% weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 5% of weekly volume.	Off.	Spend additional time on recovery.
Day 10	Z1 ski: 15% of weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 11	Hill Bounding, 6x10 sec with 2-min recovery between.	Off.	
Day 12	Travel, easy run, or ski post travel.	Off.	
Day 13	A level race.	Off.	
Day 14	Long Z1 or recovery pace before travel.	Off.	Optional A level race.

Fig. 12.11 Continued, Week 2



A competitor during Adamello Ski Raid competition. Italy. Photo: Federico Modica

Scenario Two: Back-to-back A level race weekends.

These are important races, so you need to be rested going in and then recover well between weekends. There will really be no chance to do capacity-building training during the inter-race week or you will not recover. Maintenance work is all you should plan. Plan a high-tempo workout and an aerobic maintenance session. The rest should be recovery or technique work. There is nothing you can do in such a short window that will make you faster, but a lot of things you can do that will make you slower.

Scenario Three: B/C level race leading into A level race.

It can be useful to plan a B or C level race as a preparation leading to an important race. Treat this race like a hard workout and take a light day on either side of the race; make the race the hard workout for the week. This type of race—where there is little pressure—should allow you to relax and try new strategies and pacing. Since racing experience is invaluable, use these days not only for physical training but mental training. An example two-week period where you are using these low-priority events to build toward an A level race might look like the following.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 1	Active recovery: stretch, swim, foam roll.	Spend additional time on recovery.	For volume these weeks, use the average volume in late Base Period recovery weeks.
Day 2	Z4: 15% weekly vertical. Time in Z4 less than 5% of weekly volume.	Off.	
Day 3	Z1 ski: 15% weekly vertical.	Off.	
Day 4	Hill Bounding and tempo.	Off.	
Day 5	Travel. Easy run or ski post travel.	Off.	
Day 6	Race B/C level.	Off.	
Day 7	Z1 or recovery workout on gentle terrain.	Off.	Get recovered.

Fig. 12.12 Sample Two-Week Training Plan Before Using B/C Races in Preparation for an A Race

Note: The percentages in these tables are rough guidelines.

	AM	PM	Comments
Day 8	Z1 or recovery workout on gentle terrain. Get recovered.	Off.	For volume these weeks, use the average volume in late Base Period recovery weeks.
Day 9	Short Z4: less than 5% of weekly volume in Z4.	Off.	
Day 10	Hill Bounding and quick-tempo pick-ups.	Off.	
Day 11	Z1 ski: 10% weekly vertical in Z2 bumping into Z3 if feeling good. Time in Z3 less than 5% of weekly volume.	Off.	
Day 12	Travel. Easy run or ski post travel to shake out legs.	Off.	
Day 13	A level race.	Off.	
Day 14	Z1 or short recovery workout before travel.	Off.	

